

Jannice Salazar
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Dear Members of the Hiring Committee,

It is both an honor and a privilege to write this letter in support of Dr. Vladislav Veksler's promotion at Caldwell University.

When I first enrolled at Caldwell, I was pursuing a career path that ultimately wasn't the right fit for me. Halfway through my sophomore year, I made the decision to change my major to Computer Science. At that point I had very little programming experience, yet I was determined to finish the degree on time. The road ahead felt overwhelming, but by the end of that year, I knew I'd made the right call and was eager for what came next.

That excitement grew even stronger during my junior year, when I took Computer Programming I with Dr. Veksler. He is one of the most exceptional educators I have ever had. What immediately stood out was his ability to reach every type of learner—visual, verbal, and kinesthetic—often within a single lecture. He broke complex concepts down to a granular level, so even the most intimidating material felt approachable. I never left his class feeling overwhelmed; I left feeling confident in what I'd learned. He also made a point of welcoming questions, no matter how many, and took the time to explain things in a different manner to ensure he was getting his point across.

While others just teach courses, Dr. Veksler makes a profound difference in people's lives. He understands how people learn and designs his lectures around that. Years later, I still remember not just the concepts he taught, but the confidence he instilled in me. He was the first professor who truly saw my potential, and the opportunities he gave me shaped my academic and professional path in ways I'm still grateful for. His generosity extends well beyond my own experience. Classmates consistently sought him out for guidance, and it seemed like everyone I knew wanted to take his courses whenever they could. Especially as a TA, I repeatedly heard students praise not just his teaching style but his patience and genuine investment in their success. I also saw firsthand how much time he devoted to mentoring students in research, helping them, and myself, reach opportunities they never imagined possible.

As I took more of his classes, it became clear how deeply invested he was in every student's success. His passion for coding is contagious, and it changed how I saw the tech field entirely. As a result, I found myself studying less by memorizing material as I left every class with a deep understanding of his lessons. He must have recognized that enthusiasm, because he invited me to become a Teaching Assistant for Computer Programming I the following spring, a role I continued into the fall while taking additional courses with him. Around the same time, I joined a research team under his guidance, where my teammates and I developed a UI/UX touch-based coding prototype. Throughout the project, he gave us the freedom to explore, create, and grow as researchers while providing unwavering support behind the scenes.

One of the greatest opportunities he gave me was encouraging me to present our research, *Comparing Touch-Based Coding to Traditional Computer Programming Methods*, at the 28th Annual Conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE) in Albany, New York. Being accepted to present at this conference was a defining moment in my academic career—one I may never have had without his encouragement.

What makes Dr. Veksler especially remarkable is that his curiosity extends far beyond the classroom. Despite already being an accomplished professor and researcher, he never stops challenging himself—pursuing new ideas, developing his own programming language, and taking on ambitious projects simply because he wants to keep learning. Watching someone with his expertise stay this hungry has shaped how I think about my own career. He's shown me that true mastery isn't a destination; it's a lifelong commitment to curiosity and growth. I hope to build a career as successful and fulfilling as his, but more than any title or accomplishment, I hope to carry the same passion for my work that he brings to his every day. He has become the kind of professional I aspire to be: someone who never stops learning, improving, or lifting others up along the way.

Without question, I strongly and wholeheartedly support Dr. Vladislav Veksler's promotion. His dedication to teaching, mentorship, research, and lifelong learning embodies the very best of what higher education should represent. Promoting him is not only recognition of his extraordinary contributions but an investment in the countless students whose lives he will continue to shape for years to come. Caldwell University is fortunate to have an educator of his caliber, and I cannot think of anyone more deserving of this promotion.

Thank you for your time and consideration. Please don't hesitate to contact me if any additional information would be helpful.

Sincerely,

Jannice Salazar